

# Antarctica

## Official flag

Antarctica is governed by many countries under the Antarctica Treaty System. Member countries agreed on a flag in 2002, which features the continent's map in white.



The blue background of the map represents neutrality.



- 📏 5,500,000 sq miles (14,200,000 sq km)
- 🏠 No permanent residents
- ★ None
- 🗣️ No known language

Antarctica is the **coldest, driest, and windiest continent** on Earth. This **vast frozen landmass** contains **90 percent** of the **world's ice**. It is surrounded by the **Southern Ocean**.

South Georgia  
South Sandwich Islands  
Scotia Sea  
South Orkney Islands



0 600 km  
0 600 miles  
(approximate scale)



## Amundsen-Scott Station

This US base, at the South Pole, is one of many permanent scientific research stations on the continent. In the summer, there are up to 4,000 researchers in Antarctica.



## First to the Pole

In a grueling race to be the first person ever to reach the South Pole, in 1911, Norwegian explorer Roald Amundsen (above) beat British explorer Robert F. Scott.

## Mount Erebus

This is the world's southernmost active volcano. It stands 12,448 ft (3,794 m) above sea level and has a boiling lava lake at the top.



## Penguin colony

About half a million emperor penguins—the biggest and tallest species of penguin—live in Antarctica. They gather in huge colonies to breed and raise chicks and walk long distances across the ice to feed from the sea.

